

Why Gen Z is Living Now

They have made a quiet decision that if the world is uncertain, they will not postpone happiness. That's not carelessness. That's courage.



BY ALPANA PARIDA
FOUNDER & CEO,
TVARRA

Gen Z grew up seeing careers disappear overnight, cities shut down, oceans rise, and “safe” companies lay off people on a call

EVERY GENERATION has a savings story. For those of us who were born before the '80s, it was built on fear. Growing up in post-Independence India or the liberalisation decade, frugality was not a virtue; it was survival. Saving was an insurance policy against scarcity with unstable jobs, limited credit, weak safety nets, and social expectations that one must “settle down” early.

Fear of job loss. Fear of illness. Fear of the one rainy day that would surely arrive and stay. We saved first, lived later, and congratulated ourselves for our discipline.

Gen Z watched us from an early age and reached a different conclusion. “You saved, and the rain still came.” Theirs was a different psychological economy.

They grew up seeing careers disappear overnight, cities shut down, oceans rise, and “safe” companies lay off people on Zoom. So, when we tell them to save for tomorrow, they politely smile and use their maxed-out credit cards to book a trip.

This isn't irresponsibility. It's realism with a will to live life fuller, not merely wealthier. The YOLO generation isn't hedonistic. It is emotionally honest.

Looking at their drivers of consumption across categories, we see

very different behaviours shaped by their world view.

THE WEEKEND BINGE

Where we drank occasionally to escape, or to unwind, Gen Z drinks in bursts—to celebrate. They don't nurse a nightly drink; they demolish weekends. Alcohol isn't a coping mechanism, it's a punctuation mark in the living of life.

Hence, they binge on weekends and have dry weekdays. They prefer craft beers over “my father's whisky”; low-alcohol, flavoured, Instagram-friendly drinks.

For our generation, owning a vehicle was a milestone. First job, first EMI, a legitimate pride enhancing dent. Gen Z looks at this and asks, “Why would I commit to metal for seven years?”

They want movement, not mortgages. A car isn't adulthood anymore. It's baggage. It's an albatross.

This BUY vs USE behaviour is evident across many high-value categories like real estate, jewellery and furniture. If people owned to feel safe, Gen Z uses things and moves on. We bought gadgets hoping they would last. Gen Z buys them assuming they won't. They don't mourn obsolescence. They plan for it.

Phones are traded like moods. Headphones are fashion. Watches talk back. If a device doesn't inte-